

Odyssey Mini Essay V2

California CCSS ELA Standards Alignment

OBJECTIVES	CODE ASSIGNMENTS	HIGH CONFIDENCE	GRADE BAND
13 8 aligned · 5 not	10 8 distinct standards	9 1 med · 0 low	9-10/11-12 inferred from context

Curated by gemini-1.5-flash via run_alignment.py.

Section 1: Project Setup

GradeFlow Intro

This task is designed to get you up to speed on using GradeFlow. Do not continue until you have earned all points on this task. Locate the text, # Watch # , in your Google Document. Watch the linked video and complete the tasks. You can also find the video in the Resources section for this task.

sections[0].objectives[0]

Note: The objective is logistical, focusing on onboarding students to a tool (GradeFlow) by watching an instructional video, which does not align with academic content standards.

The objective is logistical, focusing on onboarding students to a tool (GradeFlow) by watching an instructional video, which does not align with academic content standards.

MLA Heading

Create your MLA heading at the very top left of your document. Start on the first line without skipping any lines. Type these four items, each on its own line: Your full name (first and last) Your teacher's name (include Mr., Mrs., Ms., or another title) Your class name Today's date in this format: Day Month Year (Example: 13 May 2025) Use Times New Roman font, size 12. Keep everything lined up on the left. Do not make anything bold, underlined, or italicized.

sections[0].objectives[1]

L.9-10.3.a

L

categorized-standardsCaliforniaCA-ELA

Grade 9-10

Knowledge of Language

90 / 100
HIGH

Write and edit work so that it conforms to the guidelines in a style manual (e.g., MLA Handbook, Turabian's Manual for Writers) appropriate for the discipline and writing type.

WHY THIS MAPS

The objective explicitly instructs students on how to format an MLA heading, which directly aligns with conforming to the guidelines of a style manual like the MLA Handbook.

Essay Title

Watch the task video for step-by-step instructions for this task. After your heading, skip one blank line. Then type your essay title. Your title should tell the reader what your essay is about. Style your title as a 'Title' style and then format with the following attributes. Center align Times New Roman 12-point font

sections[0].objectives[2]

Note: The objective is logistical, focusing on watching an instructional video and applying specific word-processing formatting constraints (font size, style, alignment, and line spacing) to an essay title, which does not directly align with academic standards.

The objective is logistical, focusing on watching an instructional video and applying specific word-processing formatting constraints (font size, style, alignment, and line spacing) to an essay title, which does not directly align with academic standards.

Section 2: Prewriting

Introduction

Scroll down in your document to find the Prewriting section. You will see tables to help you plan your introduction paragraph. Fill out each table: Hook: Write one sentence that grabs the reader's attention and introduces the idea of heroism. Make it interesting so readers want to keep reading. Table - T#01Intro#Hook Background: Write notes about The Odyssey. Include the title, the author (Homer), and a short summary. Mention at least one character or event from the story. Table - T#02Intro#Background Thesis: Answer this question in one clear sentence: Is Odysseus truly a hero? This sentence will tell readers your main argument. Table - T#03Intro#Thesis You can use the AI Helper for idea generation and feedback on the quality of your hook statement. You can find the link in the header of your Google Doc. Top right corner.

sections[1].objectives[0]

W.9-10.2.a

categorized-standards|California|CA-ELA

Grade 9-10

Text Types and Purposes

90 / 100
HIGH

Introduce a topic or thesis statement; organize complex ideas, concepts, and information to make important connections and distinctions; include formatting (e.g., headings), graphics (e.g., figures, tables), and multimedia when useful to aiding comprehension.

WHY THIS MAPS

The objective directly instructs students to draft the introduction of an essay, specifically guiding them to write a hook, background information, and a thesis statement, which aligns perfectly with introducing a topic and thesis statement in W.9-10.2.a.

Topic and Commentary

Scroll down in your document to find the Prewriting section. You will see tables to help you plan your body paragraph. Fill out each table in order: Topic Sentence: Write one sentence that explains your main idea about Odysseus. Table - T#04Body#Topic Evidence #1: Select and write out a strong quote from The Odyssey that supports your position on Odysseus's heroism. Include context about what is happening in the story. Table - T#05Body#Evidence1 Commentary 1.1: Draft 1-2 sentences explaining how this quote connects to your thesis within the context of The Odyssey . Table - T#06Body#Commentary1.1 Commentary 1.2: Draft 1-2 sentences explaining how this quote connects to your thesis in the real world and modern ideas of heroism. Table - T#07Body#Commentary1.2 Be thoughtful in your planning, but don't worry about writing perfectly. These ideas and notes will serve as the blueprint for your body paragraph, resulting in a stronger final essay. You can use the AI Helper for idea generation and feedback on the quality of your hook statement. You can find the link in the header of your Google Doc. Top right corner.

sections[1].objectives[1]

W.9-10.2.a

W

categorized-sta
ndards\Californi
al\CA-ELA

Grade
9-10

Text Types and Purposes

90 / 100
HIGH

Introduce a topic or thesis statement; organize complex ideas, concepts, and information to make important connections and distinctions; include formatting (e.g., headings), graphics (e.g., figures, tables), and multimedia when useful to aiding comprehension.

WHY THIS MAPS

The objective guides students through organizing a body paragraph by drafting a topic sentence, selecting supporting evidence, and writing commentary to make connections to their thesis, which directly aligns with organizing complex ideas and introducing a topic under W.9-10.2.a.

Commentary and Conclusion

Scroll down in your document to find the Prewriting section. You will see tables to help you plan your body paragraph. Fill out each table in order: Evidence #2: Select and write out a second strong quote from The Odyssey that further supports your argument. Table - T#08Body#Evidence2 Commentary 2.1: Draft 1-2 sentences explaining how this second quote connects to your thesis within Homer's epic. Table - T#09Body#Commentary2.1 Commentary 2.2: Draft 1-2 sentences explaining how this quote relates to contemporary perspectives on heroism. Table - T#10Body#Commentary2.2 Concluding Sentence(s): Draft one or two sentences that restate your thesis and wrap up your main points, emphasizing their importance. Table - T#11Body#Concluding Be thoughtful in your planning, but don't worry about writing perfectly. These ideas and notes will serve as the blueprint for your body paragraph, resulting in a stronger final essay. You can use the AI Helper for idea generation and feedback on the quality of your hook statement. You can find the link in the header of your Google Doc. Top right corner.

sections[1].objectives[2]

W.9-10.1.e

W

categorized-standardsCaliforniaCA-ELA

Grade 9-10

Text Types and Purposes

90 / 100
HIGH

Provide a concluding statement or section that follows from and supports the argument presented.

WHY THIS MAPS

The objective explicitly requires students to draft concluding sentences that restate their thesis and wrap up their main points, directly aligning with the standard's focus on providing a concluding statement that supports the argument.

Insert Sections 1 - 3.

You will need to watch the task video for this one . You need to insert three Section Break (continuous) in your Google Document. This is what enables GradeFlow to accurately identify your Introduction and Body paragraphs. Not doing this will result in a much lower grade. Insert a blank line below your title, then insert a Section Break (continuous) . Type "Intro Paragraph" below the section break. Insert a blank line below "Intro Paragraph", then insert a Section Break (continuous) . Type "Body Paragraph" below the section break. Insert a blank line below "Body Paragraph", then insert a Section Break (continuous) . Do not continue until you have earned all points for this task .

sections[2].objectives[0]

Note: The objective is purely logistical and formatting-focused, instructing the student on how to insert section breaks in a Google Document so that a grading tool (GradeFlow) can parse it. It does not align with academic ELA standards.

The objective is purely logistical and formatting-focused, instructing the student on how to insert section breaks in a Google Document so that a grading tool (GradeFlow) can parse it. It does not align with academic ELA standards.

Introduction Paragraph

Write your introduction paragraph now. Your introduction has three jobs: grab attention, give background information, and state your main argument. Your introduction paragraph must include all of the following: Indent the first line in this paragraph. Hook : Begin with an attention-grabbing sentence. Background : Mention the title of the epic, the author, and a brief summary that includes at least one character's name. Thesis : Present a clear thesis statement introducing the ideas of your argument. Length: 3–4 sentences Word count: 75–200 words

sections[2].objectives[1]

W.9-10.2.a

W

categorized-standardsCaliforniaCA-ELA

Grade 9-10

Text Types and Purposes

90 / 100
HIGH

Introduce a topic or thesis statement; organize complex ideas, concepts, and information to make important connections and distinctions; include formatting (e.g., headings), graphics (e.g., figures, tables), and multimedia when useful to aiding comprehension.

WHY THIS MAPS

The objective requires students to write an introduction paragraph that introduces a topic, provides background information on an epic, and presents a clear thesis statement, which directly aligns with introducing a topic and thesis statement in writing.

Body Paragraph

Write your body paragraph now. This paragraph proves your thesis using evidence from *The Odyssey*. Your paragraph should include these parts in this order: Indent the first line in this paragraph. Topic Sentence:

Write one sentence that states your main point about Odysseus and connects to your thesis. Evidence #1:

Give a quote from *The Odyssey*.

Before the quote, explain what is happening in the story. Commentary

#1.1 - Inside the Story: Write 1-2 sentences explaining what this quote shows about Odysseus's actions or character in the story. Commentary

#1.2 - Real World: Write 1-2 sentences explaining how this connects to heroes or leadership in today's world. Evidence #2: Give a second quote from *The Odyssey*.

Again, explain what's happening in the story before you share the quote.

Commentary #2.1 - Inside the Story: Write 1-2 sentences explaining what this second quote shows about Odysseus in Homer's epic.

Commentary #2.2 - Real World: Write 1-2 sentences explaining how this connects to modern ideas about heroism. Concluding Sentence: End

with 1-2 sentences that restate your thesis and explain why your points matter. Length : 7–10 sentences

Word count : 125–300 words

sections[2].objectives[2]

Note: None of the candidate standards align well. The lesson objective focuses on writing an analytical body paragraph about character and heroism in 'The Odyssey', which requires high school-level writing and literary analysis standards (such as W.9-10.1 or RL.9-10.3). The provided candidates are either vocabulary-focused (L.9-10.4.a), elementary-level reading standards (RL.4.3, RL.3.3), or focused on point of view/cultural experience (RL.9-10.6).

None of the candidate standards align well. The lesson objective focuses on writing an analytical body paragraph about character and heroism in 'The Odyssey', which requires high school-level writing and literary analysis standards (such as W.9-10.1 or RL.9-10.3). The provided candidates are either vocabulary-focused (L.9-10.4.a), elementary-level reading standards (RL.4.3, RL.3.3), or focused on point of view/cultural experience (RL.9-10.6).

Section 4: Teacher Graded

Prewriting Connections

Review your prewriting tables and compare them to your final essay. Make sure the quotes you planned in your prewriting appear in your body paragraph. Check that you turned your rough commentary notes into clear, complete explanations in your essay. Your final writing should show growth from your planning; this proves you used prewriting as a tool to organize and strengthen your ideas.

sections[3].objectives[0]

WHST.9-10.5

WHST

categorized-standards|California|CA-ELA

Grade
9-10

Production and Distribution
of Writing

90 / 100
HIGH

Develop and strengthen writing as needed by planning, revising, editing, rewriting, or trying a new approach, focusing on addressing what is most significant for a specific purpose and audience.

WHY THIS MAPS

The objective focuses on using prewriting to plan, review, and strengthen writing by turning rough notes into clear explanations and ensuring planned quotes are integrated.

WHST.11-12.5

WHST

categorized-standards|California|CA-ELA

Grade
11-12

Production and Distribution
of Writing

90 / 100
HIGH

Develop and strengthen writing as needed by planning, revising, editing, rewriting, or trying a new approach, focusing on addressing what is most significant for a specific purpose and audience.

WHY THIS MAPS

This standard mirrors WHST.9-10.5 for the 11-12 grade band, aligning perfectly with the objective of developing and strengthening writing through planning, revising, and editing.

Introduction Paragraph

Reread your introduction paragraph and verify these elements are present: a compelling hook about heroism, the title *The Odyssey* in italics, the author Homer's name, and a brief summary that mentions specific characters or events. Most importantly, confirm your thesis clearly states your position on whether Odysseus is a hero. Your introduction should engage readers, provide necessary context, and set up your argument.

sections[3].objectives[1]

Note: None of the candidate standards align with the objective, which focuses on writing and revising an argumentative essay introduction paragraph (specifically thesis formulation, hooks, and background context). The candidates are limited to vocabulary context clues, literature analysis, and collaborative discussions.

None of the candidate standards align with the objective, which focuses on writing and revising an argumentative essay introduction paragraph (specifically thesis formulation, hooks, and background context). The candidates are limited to vocabulary context clues, literature analysis, and collaborative discussions.

Body Paragraph

Before submitting, review your body paragraph carefully. Start with a clear topic sentence that elaborates on your thesis and provides focus for your argument about Odysseus's heroism. Locate both quotes and confirm each comes directly from The Odyssey wrapped in "double quotation marks"; not paraphrases or summaries. Check that you introduced each quote with context so readers understand where it comes from and why it matters, and verify that both quotes are relevant to heroism and support your thesis. After each quote, include two separate commentaries: the first explaining how the evidence connects to your thesis within The Odyssey, and the second explaining how it connects to real-world heroism or modern applications. Don't just retell what happened; explain why the evidence matters and how it proves your argument. Review your concluding sentences to ensure you restate your thesis using different words (not copying from your introduction), summarize your main evidence and arguments without word-for-word repetition, and explain why your position on Odysseus's heroism matters by addressing the broader significance of your analysis. Your conclusion should reinforce your argument, wrap up key points, and help readers understand why this analysis is important.

sections[3].objectives[2]

RL.11-12.1

RL

categorized-sta
ndards\Californi
al\CA-ELA

Grade
11-12

Key Ideas and Details

90 / 100
HIGH

Cite strong and thorough textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly as well as inferences drawn from the text, including determining where the text leaves matters uncertain.

WHY THIS MAPS

The objective requires students to select direct quotes from The Odyssey (a literary text) and use them to support their analysis of Odysseus's heroism, which directly aligns with citing strong and thorough textual evidence to support analysis.

Quality and Format

Before submitting, check that your essay uses analytical language and flows smoothly. Begin commentary sentences with explanation starters like "This evidence shows that...", "This fact reveals...", "One can see...", or "It is clear that..." to introduce analysis rather than summary; don't just retell what happened in the quotes. Use transition words (for example, similarly, for instance, in addition, furthermore, however, therefore) to connect ideas within and between sections, showing clear relationships between your evidence and commentary so the essay flows without abrupt jumps. Maintain academic writing conventions by avoiding informal language ("you", "your", "things", "stuff", "very", "really") and first-person phrases ("In this essay, I will..." or "I think..."). Keep a formal, objective tone suitable for literary analysis, and capitalize all proper nouns correctly, including Odysseus, Homer, and The Odyssey. Verify your formatting meets MLA requirements: use 12-point Times New Roman font throughout, double-space the entire document with no extra space between paragraphs, center-align your title, indent the first line of both paragraphs, and left-align all other text. Check that spelling, punctuation, and capitalization are correct, sentence structure is varied with proper subject-verb agreement, and your writing is clear and readable.

sections[3].objectives[3]

W.9-10.1.d

W

categorized-sta
ndards\Californi
al\CA-ELA

Grade
9-10

Text Types and Purposes

90 / 100
HIGH

Establish and maintain a formal style and objective tone while attending to the norms and conventions of the discipline in which they are writing.

WHY THIS MAPS

The objective focuses on maintaining a formal style, objective tone, and academic writing conventions for a literary analysis of 'The Odyssey' (typically taught in 9th/10th grade), which directly aligns with establishing a formal style and objective tone in argumentative writing.

W.9-10.2.e

W

categorized-sta
ndards\Californi
al\CA-ELA

Grade
9-10

Text Types and Purposes

70 / 100
MEDIUM

Establish and maintain a formal style and objective tone while attending to the norms and conventions of the discipline in which they are writing.

WHY THIS MAPS

This standard also addresses establishing and maintaining a formal style and objective tone, which is applicable if the literary analysis is framed as an informative or explanatory essay rather than an argument.